

Morning Headlines — Wednesday, 15 July 2026

A collapsing US-Iran ceasefire and a naval blockade on the world's most critical oil chokepoint dominate global attention, as trade records, a Bangkok tragedy, a World Cup semifinal, and cooling inflation fill out a consequential Wednesday.

top 5 · last 24 hours

US Reimposes Naval Blockade on Iran as Strait of Hormuz War Escalates — [CBS News](#) / [Al Jazeera](#) /

[Bloomberg](#)

~18h ago · Middle East / Global Energy

The US military restored its naval blockade of Iranian ports at 4 p.m. ET on July 14 and launched dozens of new strikes on Iranian military targets near the Strait of Hormuz — through which roughly 20% of world energy supplies pass — after a brief ceasefire collapsed. The renewed conflict is pushing oil prices higher and rattling global markets.

China's June Exports Hit Record \$412 Billion, Surging 27% on AI Boom and Tariff Rush — [CNBC](#) /

[South China Morning Post](#)

~20h ago · Economy / Trade

China's exports jumped 27% year-on-year in June to a record \$412.39 billion, far exceeding forecasts, as soaring global demand for AI data-center hardware and buyers racing ahead of new US tariffs that took effect July 1 drove the second-largest monthly trade surplus on record. The figures underscore China's continued manufacturing dominance despite rising geopolitical headwinds.

Bangkok Music Bar Fire Death Toll Rises to 30 as Police Probe Negligence — [NPR](#) / [Al Jazeera](#)

~22h ago · Southeast Asia

The death toll from a fire at the Rong Beer Na Lat Phrao live-music venue in Bangkok's Chatuchak district climbed to 30, with dozens more hospitalized in critical condition, after an electrical fault in a ceiling AC unit ignited flammable soundproofing and blocked emergency exits. Thai police are investigating possible negligence after finding beer crates and furniture obstructing escape routes.

England vs. Argentina: Football's Fiercest Rivalry Renewed in World Cup Semifinal — [Al Jazeera](#) / [FIFA](#)

~3h ago · Sports / World Cup 2026

England and Argentina met today in the FIFA World Cup 2026 semifinal in Atlanta — their first World Cup clash since 2002 — with Lionel Messi and Harry Kane headlining a match watched by billions worldwide. The winner advances to the July 19 final at MetLife Stadium in New York/New Jersey.

US Stocks Rise to Records as June CPI Shows Consumer Prices Dipped — [Charles Schwab](#) / [CNBC](#)

~6h ago · Economy / Markets

June CPI data showed monthly consumer prices fell 0.1%, with core inflation holding at 2.9% year-over-year, lifting the Dow Jones above 53,000 to a record close and bolstering hopes for a Fed rate cut before year-end. Major bank earnings from Morgan Stanley, Johnson & Johnson, and BlackRock are also due today, keeping markets on watch.